

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ K Q 9 6 3
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2

♥ A 8 5 4

♦ 4

♣ 7 4



♠ A 4 3
 ♥ J 10 2
 ♦ Q J 10 9 8
 ♣ A J

♠ K 10 8

♥ 7

♦ A 7 5 3 2

♣ 8 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	2 ♠	3 ♦	3 ♠
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
Pass	4 ♠	Dbl	
All Pass			

4 ♠ X by North

will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

North's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal South/North have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 6 4
 ♥ 6 4 2
 ♦ K 9 4 2
 ♣ A K J

♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 8 4

♠ K 8 7 3

♥ Q 10 7 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 3 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East
 cannot establish the ♠ winner.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice.
 Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from
 ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough
 to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at
 left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in
 dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick,
 which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥
 winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he